RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

20 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 2:48 PM, Tuesday 20 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 204 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 46 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 12,570 minutes at 3:00 PM (no movement since HZSK5 to Geneva at 11:05 AM); Dammam moving with no open halt

1

INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 12,570 minutes at 3:00 PM; no takeoff or landing since the 12:00 PM edition**.
- 204 Tuesday Riyadh flights cancelled (34%), and NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight.
- Defense Ministry confirms the 11:39 AM intercept of a Houthi ballistic missile over Riyadh; AFP heard two blasts, no damage or casualties reported.
- Dammam airport moving with no open halt: 9 takeoffs and 11 landings since 12 PM, latest Saudia SV1116 from Jeddah at 2:37 PM.
- Foreign airlines keep pushing Saudi restarts later, some into 2027.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (12559 min).

204	0/0	5
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

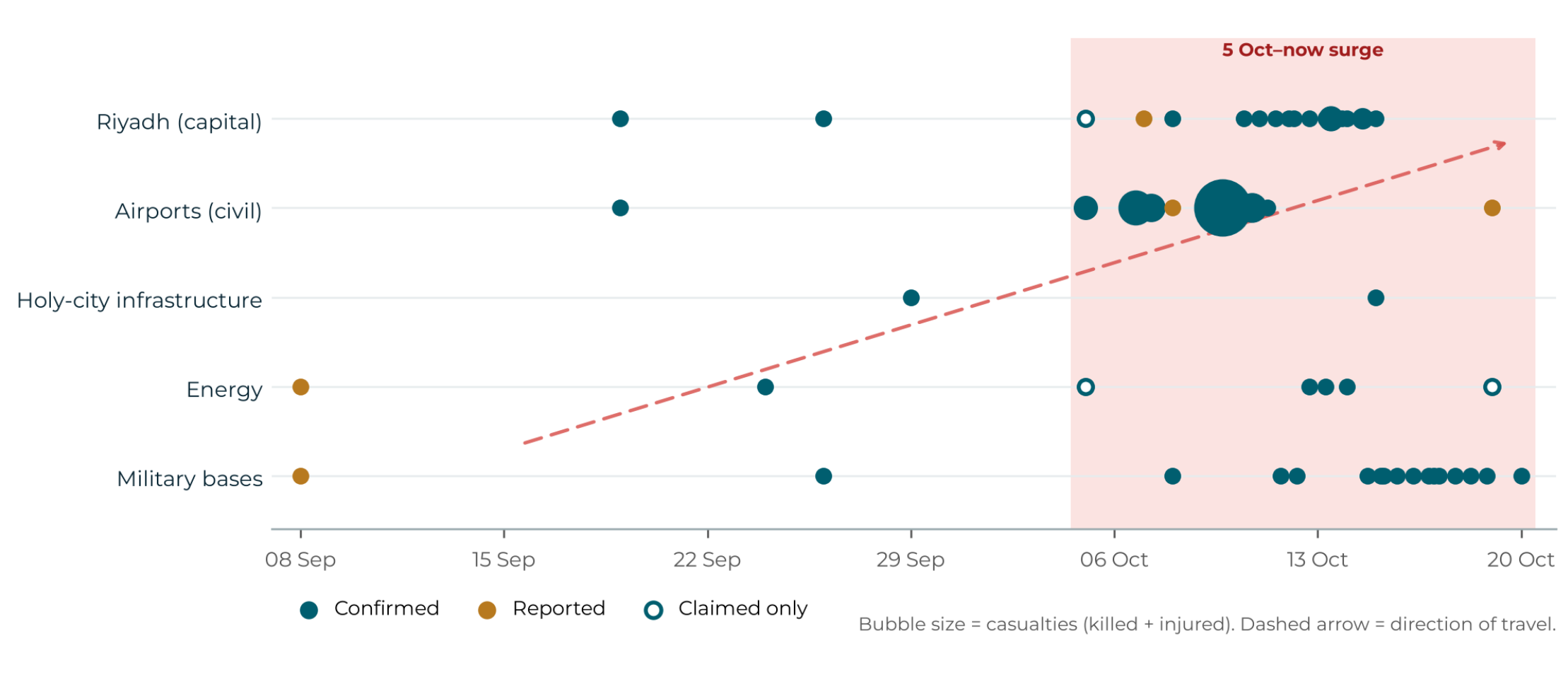
4 takeoffs and 5 landings in the last hour.

46	4/5	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (12,570 min at 3:00 PM); no takeoffs or landings since the 12:00 PM edition
- Ministry of Defense confirmed via SPA that air defenses destroyed the Houthi ballistic missile fired toward Riyadh at 11:39 AM; AFP heard two blasts, no damage or casualties reported
- No new attacks, interceptions or Civil Defense alerts since 12:00 PM
- Dammam moving, no halt since 8:11 AM: 9 takeoffs and 11 landings since 12 PM, latest SV1116 from Jeddah at 2:37 PM
- Gulf Business: foreign airlines keep delaying Saudi restarts after the Riyadh reopening, some routes into 2027

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 20 OCT



Bubble size = casualties (killed + injured). Dashed arrow = direction of travel.

53 sourced events since 8 September (45 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: Houthi ballistic missile fired toward Riyadh intercepted and destroyed, after a Civil Defense early warning for Riyadh at 11:11 AM (20 Oct, Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

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ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 12:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 12:00 PM AST.

Last 24 hours: Attacks 2, interceptions 2, alerts 4, all-clears 4.

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NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Riyadh airport still halted after the 11:39 AM missile intercept; AFP heard two blasts; airlines push Saudi restarts later

Checked at 2:50 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED King Salman chairs the Cabinet session in Riyadh

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **2:46 PM** · published 2:46 PM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 2:50 PM; no Cabinet statement published yet

State broadcaster Al Ekhbariya said the Custodian of the Two Holy Mosques is chairing the weekly Cabinet session in Riyadh. Any Cabinet statement on the Houthi attacks or the airport will be added once SPA publishes it.

CONFIRMED Gulf Business: airlines keep delaying Saudi services after the Riyadh reopening, some routes pushed into 2027

Gulf Business · **1:53 PM** · published 1:53 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; checked 2:50 PM

Gulf Business reports that although Riyadh airport formally reopened on 18 October under NOTAM A3650/26 (prior GACA permission for every flight), many foreign carriers have extended suspensions into late October, November or 2027.

CORROBORATED AFP: two blasts heard in Riyadh as the Houthi missile was intercepted; Ministry of Defense confirms

AFP; SPA (Ministry of Defense) · **12:47 PM** · AFP story published 12:47 PM AST Tue 20 Oct (Dhaka Tribune, Gulf Times); SPA Ministry of Defense statement; checked 2:50 PM

AFP journalists in the capital reported two blasts after the 11:11 AM Civil Defense warning. The Ministry of Defense said through SPA that Royal Saudi Air Defense intercepted and destroyed the ballistic missile launched toward Riyadh. No damage or casualties have been reported.

CONFIRMED Coalition: Houthi ballistic missile fired toward Riyadh intercepted and destroyed

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **11:39 AM** · published 11:39 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); SPA and Al Ekhbariya 11:41 AM; checked 11:58 AM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki said a ballistic missile launched by the Houthis toward Riyadh was intercepted and destroyed. No debris, damage or casualties have been reported so far. Al Jazeera, Al Arabiya and AFP-relayed outlets carried the statement within minutes.

CONFIRMED Saudi Civil Defense: early-warning alert for Riyadh City at 11:11 AM, all-clear at 11:17 AM

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **11:11 AM** · alert 11:11 AM, all-clear 11:17 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account); Al Ekhbariya relayed both; checked 11:58 AM

Civil Defense issued a warning through the National Early Warning Platform for Riyadh City, then said the danger had passed six minutes later. It again warned that filming or sharing information about interceptions or impact sites exposes people to legal liability.

CONFIRMED IndiGo: Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam and Medina flights cancelled through 24 October

IndiGo (@IndiGo6E) · **11:20 AM** · airline reply to a passenger, 11:20 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official airline account); checked 11:58 AM

IndiGo told a passenger that after assessing the situation in Saudi Arabia, its flights to and from Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam and Medina stay cancelled until 24 October inclusive.

UNVERIFIED Skift, citing Cirium: about a third of Saudi flights did not operate Monday; says Riyadh airport reopened Sunday

Skift (@skift) · **9:02 AM** · posted 9:02 AM AST Tue 20 Oct; checked 11:58 AM; not matched by the Flightradar24 Riyadh board

Skift reports Cirium data showing about a third of scheduled flights from Saudi Arabia were cancelled or did not fly on Monday, down from more than half on Sunday, and says Riyadh airport reopened Sunday. The Riyadh board still shows no scheduled airline takeoff or landing since 11 October; the only movements are non-scheduled flights.

CONFIRMED Riyadh airport tells passengers to follow official airspace updates and check with their airline

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **8:43 AM** · latest reply 8:43 AM AST Tue 20 Oct to a passenger (official account, Arabic, translated); same reply at 3:20 AM and 9:11 PM Mon; checked 8:54 AM

King Khalid International Airport keeps answering passengers who ask whether flights are running with the same line: follow the official authorities for airspace updates and check with the airline they booked with. It gave no reopening time for scheduled flights.

CONFIRMED Yemeni government forces report 1,164 targeting operations against the Houthis in Yemen in 24 hours

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:18 AM** · published 5:18 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 5:50 AM

Saudi state broadcaster Al Ekhbariya, citing the Yemeni Armed Forces, reported 1,164 targeting operations against the Houthi militia in the past 24 hours as part of the "Dawn of Yemen" operations. The figure comes from the Yemeni government side and has not been independently checked.

CONFIRMED Yemen's Presidential Council head Rashad al-Alimi asks UN chief Guterres to enforce the arms embargo on the Houthis

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **3:25 AM** · published 3:25 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 5:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported that Rashad al-Alimi, head of Yemen's Presidential Leadership Council, asked UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres to enforce the ban on arms supplies to the Houthi militia.

CONFIRMED US State Department: US government staff need special authorization to use any Saudi airport

US State Dept travel (@TravelGov); US Mission Saudi Arabia (@USAinKSA) · **11:17 PM** · published 11:17 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); repeated as a US Mission security alert at 12:40 AM Tue 20 Oct; checked 2:50 AM

The State Department reminded US citizens in Saudi Arabia to follow the national alerts Saudi Civil Defense sends by cellular broadcast. It said US government employees working in the Kingdom need special authorization from the Chief of Mission to use any airport in Saudi Arabia. The US Mission in Saudi Arabia reissued the same guidance as a formal security alert at 12:40 AM.

CONFIRMED FII Institute postpones the FII10 investor conference in Riyadh to 2027

SPA (@Spa_Eng); FII Institute; CNBC, The National · **10:49 PM** · SPA published 10:49 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); FII Institute statement and CNBC first at 6:14 PM AST; checked 11:58 PM

Saudi Press Agency confirmed at 10:49 PM that the FII Institute has postponed FII10, due 26 to 29 October at the King Abdulaziz International Conference Center in Riyadh, to 2027, with new dates to come and registrations still valid. The statement does not cite security, but CNBC, The National, WSJ and FT link the decision to the escalating Houthi missile and drone attacks, including the 10 October strike on Riyadh airport.

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KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (12559 min).

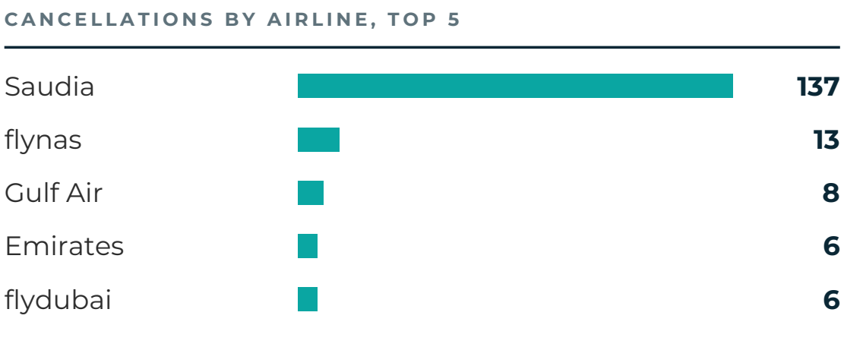
204	11:05 AM	8:43 PM	0	5
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
96 departures + 108 arrivals, 34% of 594 scheduled.	HZSK5 to Geneva (non-airline flight), 222 min before 2:48 PM.	N437GA from Athens, 1085 min before 2:48 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Dammam, Jeddah.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 2:48 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 194 at 2:48 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

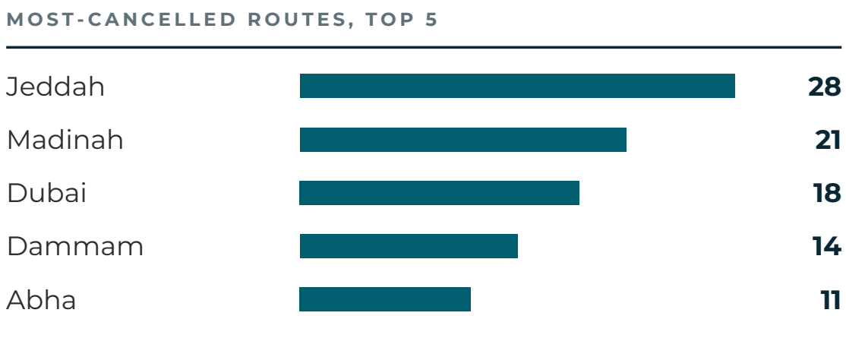
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	96	108	204	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	89 (30%)	105 (35%)	194	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	2 (1%)	1 (0%)	3	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	4 (67%)	3 (75%)	7	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	1 of 176	0 of 141	1 of 317	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	5	5	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	19	23	42	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	72	100	172	FR24 stats panel

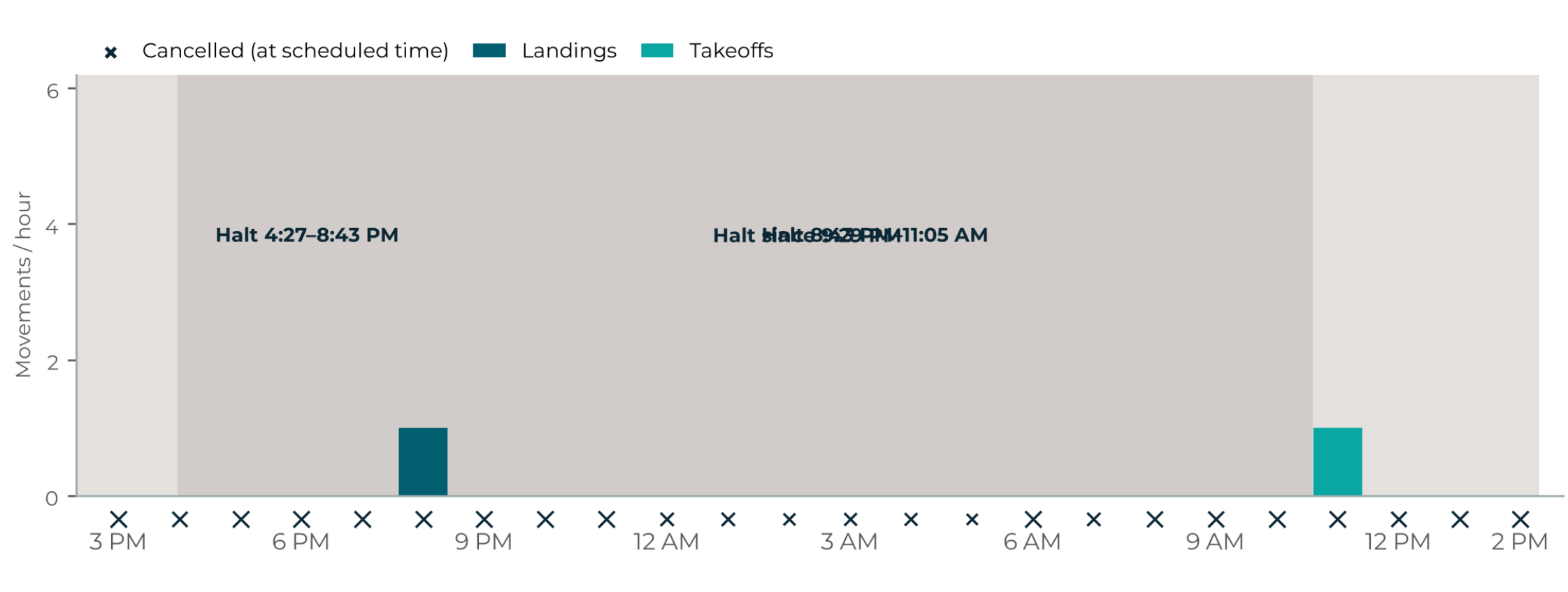
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



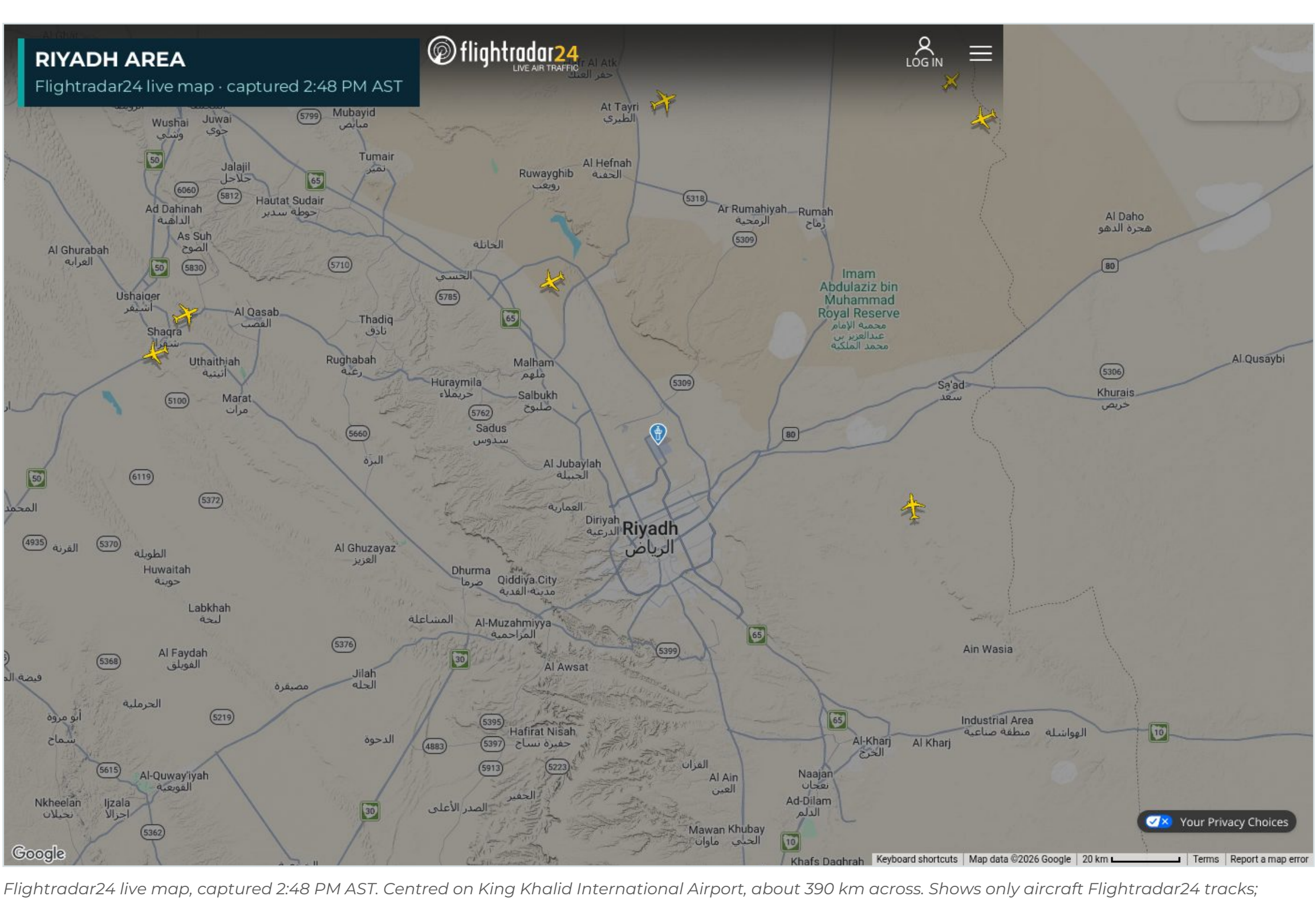
Recorded takeoffs (1) and landings (1) at RUH per hour from 3:00 PM Monday to 2:48 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are non-scheduled flights: landings SV918 at 4:27 PM and N437GA at 8:43 PM Monday, and the private-jet takeoff HZSK5 to Geneva at 11:05 AM Tuesday. Dammam's halts in the window ran 12:41–1:48 AM, 2:04–2:53 AM, 5:15–6:17 AM and 7:13–8:11 AM Tuesday; Dammam has had no halt since 8:11 AM; its longest gap since 12:00 PM was 17 minutes.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 8:43 PM–11:05 AM	862 min
Halt 4:27–8:43 PM	256 min
OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	12559 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA


RIYADH AREA
Flightradar24 live map · captured 2:48 PM AST
flightradar24
Riyadh
Imam Abdulaziz bin Muhammad Royal Reserve
Google

Flightradar24 live map, captured 2:48 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: disrupted. 4 takeoffs and 5 landings in the last hour.

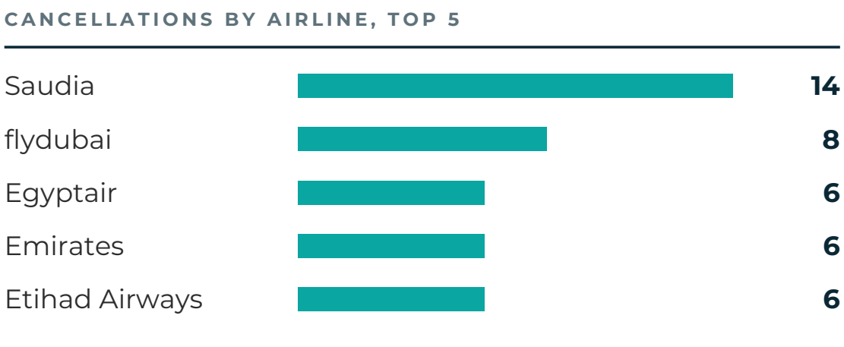
46	2:32 PM	2:37 PM	4	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
22 departures + 24 arrivals, 21% of 220 scheduled.	ME447 to Beirut, 16 min before 2:48 PM.	SV1116 from Jeddah, 10 min before 2:48 PM.	5 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 2:48 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 45 at 2:49 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

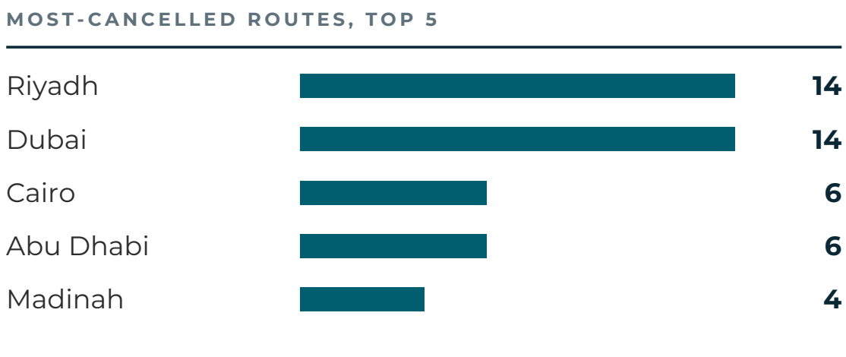
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	22	24	46	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	22 (19%)	23 (21%)	45	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	15 (13%)	10 (9%)	25	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	18 (55%)	18 (64%)	36	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	9 min	8 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	34 of 59	30 of 56	64 of 115	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	10	14	24	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	15	18	33	FR24 stats panel

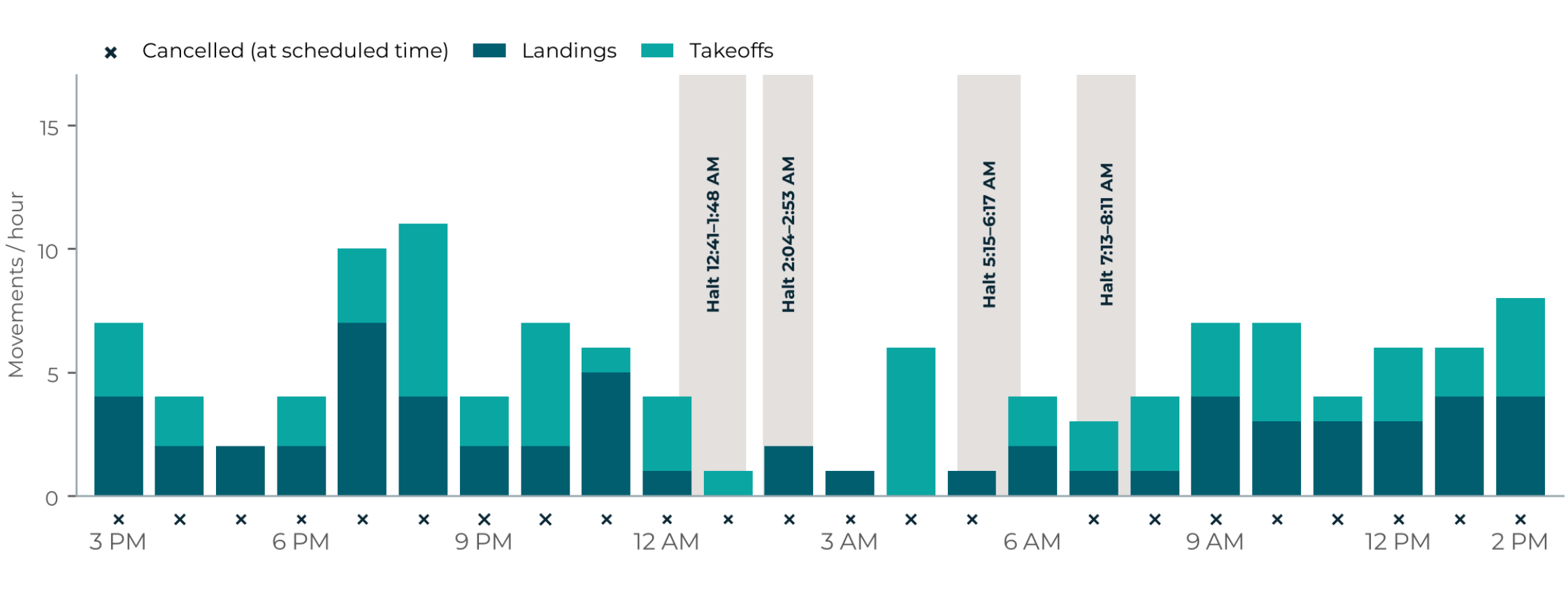
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (59) and landings (60) at DMM per hour from 3:00 PM Monday to 2:48 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Moving, no open halt at 3:00 PM: 4 takeoffs and 5 landings in the last hour; 9 takeoffs and 11 landings since 12 PM; no new halt since the last edition.

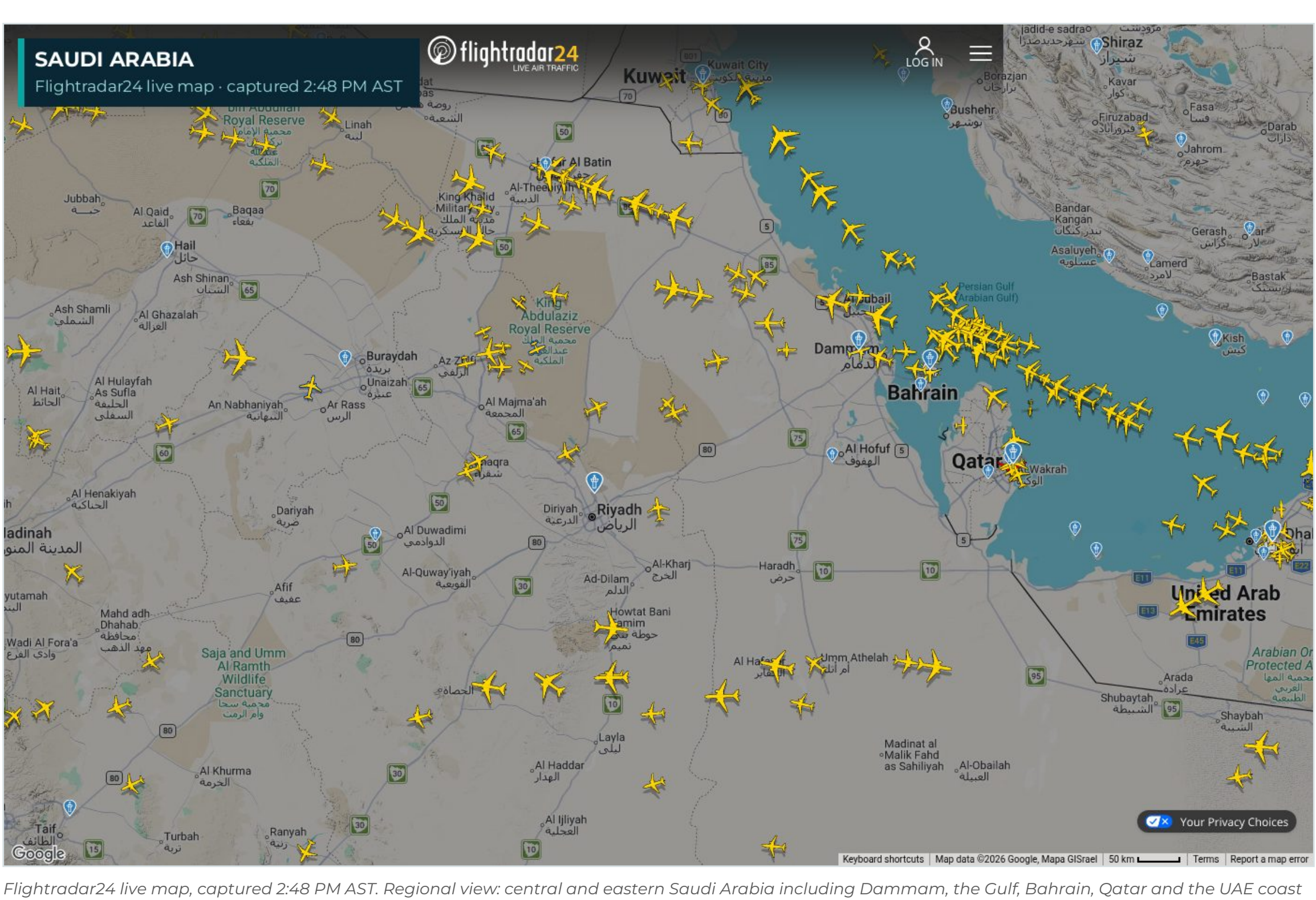
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 7:13–8:11 AM	58 min
Halt 5:15–6:17 AM	62 min
Halt 2:04–2:53 AM	49 min
Halt 12:41–1:48 AM	66 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (2:50 PM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 2:48 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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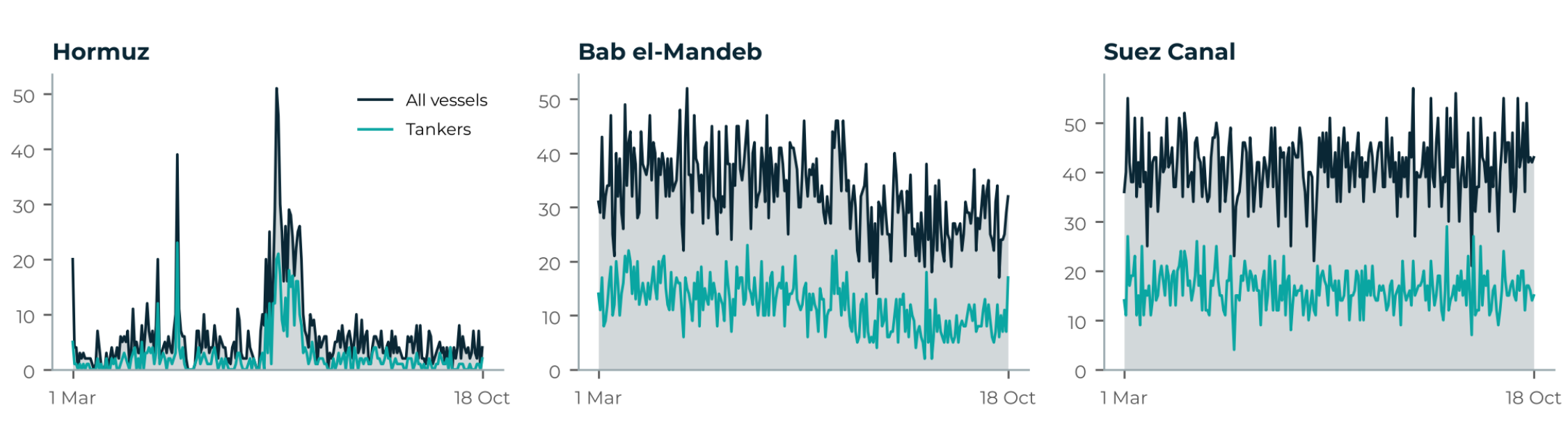
ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

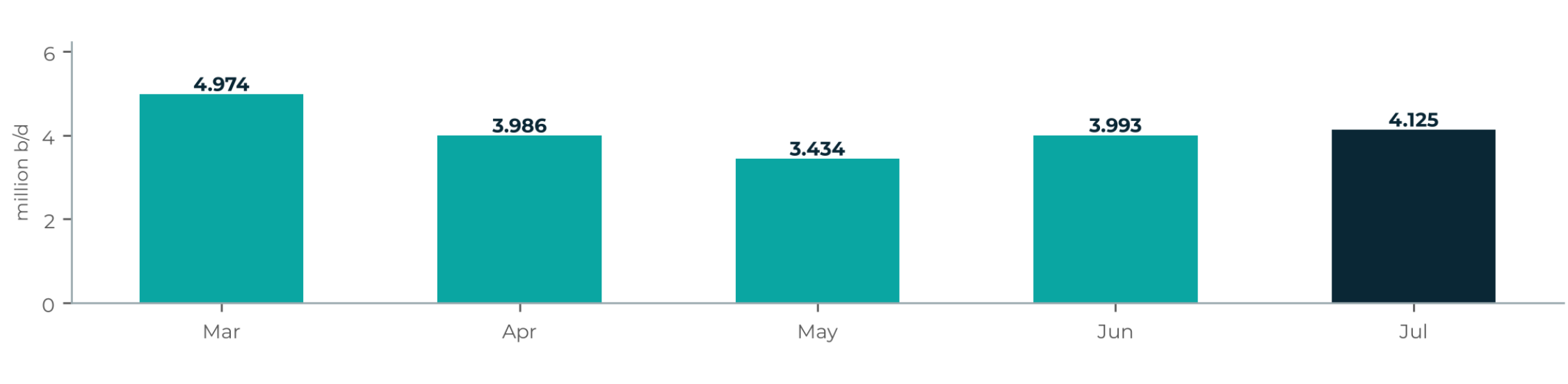
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 18 Oct	**4**	2	2	3.7 (4.1)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 18 Oct	**32**	17	15	26.4 (28.3)
Suez Canal	Sun 18 Oct	**43**	15	28	44.3 (41.7)



Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. ***Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.*** *Fetched 2:49 PM, Tue 20 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

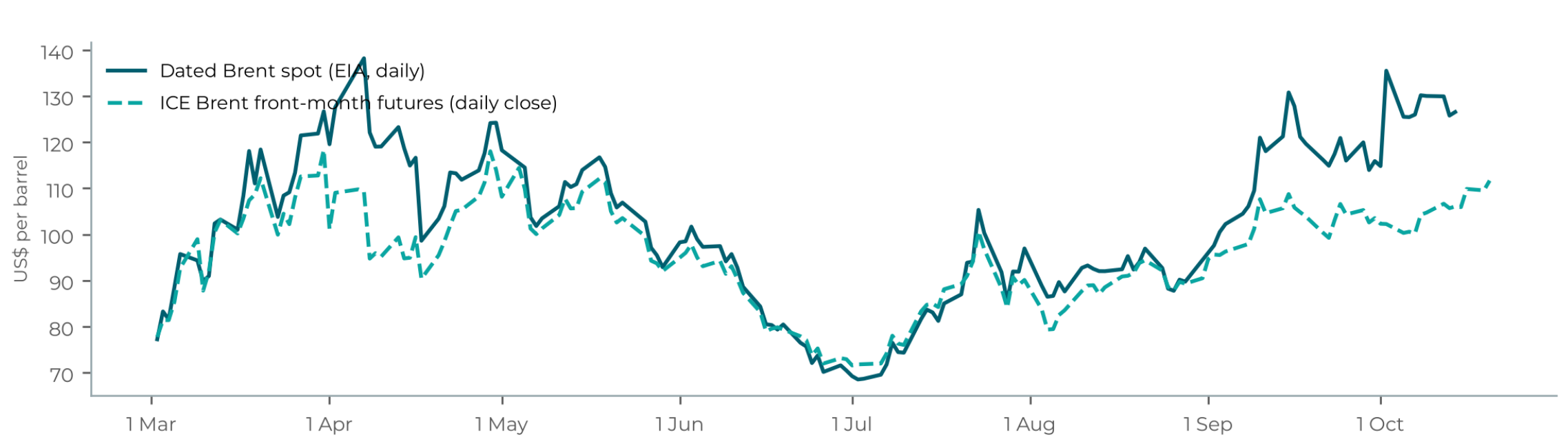


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$111.67	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 2:39 PM, Tue 20 Oct AST (+1.9% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

7

METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 2:48 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
2:48 PM, Tue 20 Oct	2:48 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	6:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 6:00 PM